

Practice Paper 4

English

Read the following carefully:

1. **Do not open or turn over the page in this booklet until you are told to do so.**
 2. You have to read a passage and then answer some questions about it. You can look back at the passage to check your answers as many times as you want. There are also some grammar, spelling and punctuation exercises to do.
 3. This is a multiple-choice test in which you have to mark your answer to each question on the answer sheet. You should mark only one answer for each question.
 4. Draw a firm line clearly through the rectangle next to your answer like this . If you make a mistake, rub it out as completely as you can and put in your new answer.
 5. Be sure to keep your place on the answer sheet. Mark your answer in the box that has the same number as the question.
 6. You may not be able to finish all the questions, but try to do as many as you can. If you cannot do a question, do not waste time on it but go on to the next. If you are not sure of an answer, choose the one you think is best.
 7. You may do any rough working on a separate sheet of paper.
 8. **Work as quickly and as carefully as you can.**
 9. You will have 45 minutes to do the test.
-

Read this passage carefully, then answer the questions that follow.

Colonel Fazackerley

by Charles Causley

1. Colonel Fazackerley Butterworth-Toast,
Bought an old castle complete with a ghost,
But someone or other forgot to declare,
To Colonel Fazack that the spectre was there.
5. On the very first evening, while waiting to dine,
The Colonel was taking a fine sherry wine,
When the ghost, with a furious flash and a flare,
Shot out of the chimney and shivered, 'Beware!'

Colonel Fazackerley put down his glass,

10. And said, 'My dear fellow, that's really first class!
I just can't conceive how you do it at all.
I imagine you're going to a Fancy Dress Ball?'

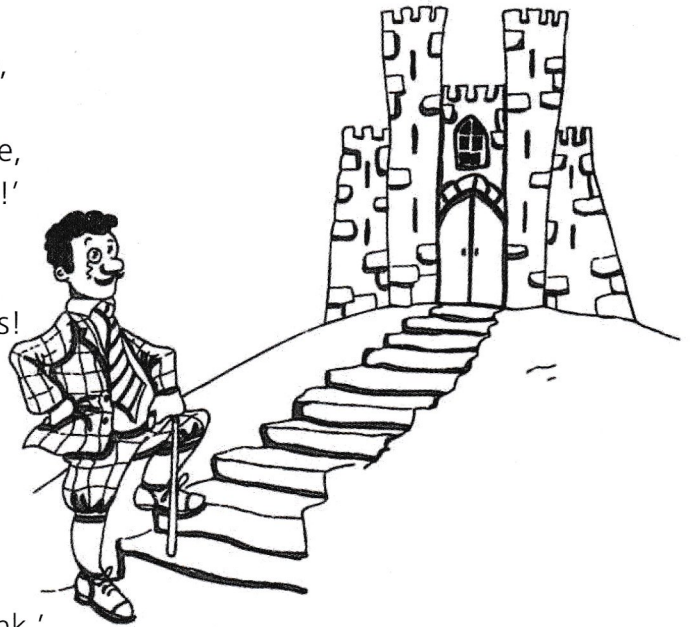
At this, the dread ghost gave a withering cry.
Said the Colonel (his monocle firm in his eye),

15. 'Now just how you do it, I wish I could think.
Do sit down and tell me, and please have a drink.'

The ghost in his phosphorous cloak gave a roar,
And floated about between ceiling and floor.
He walked through a wall and returned through a pane,

20. And backed up the chimney and came down again.

Said the Colonel, 'With laughter I'm feeling quite weak!'
(As trickles of merriment ran down his cheek).
'My house-warming party I hope you won't spurn.
You MUST say you'll come and you'll give us a turn!'



Please answer these questions. (Look at the passage again if you need to.)
You should choose the **best** answer and mark its letter on your answer sheet.

1

When did Colonel Fazackerley first see the ghost?

- A during breakfast
- B just before lunch
- C just before dinner
- D during dinner
- E in the middle of the night

2

Why had the Colonel not seen the ghost before?

- A The Colonel had only just moved into the castle.
- B The ghost had only just arrived at the castle.
- C The Colonel had been away from home.
- D The ghost had been hiding.
- E The Colonel did not believe in ghosts.

3

**‘When the ghost, with a furious flash and a flare,
Shot out of the chimney and shivered, “Beware!”’ (lines 7–8)**

Which word suggests that the ghost is trying to frighten the Colonel?

- A furious
- B flash
- C flare
- D Shot
- E Beware

4

What was the Colonel’s initial reaction to the ghost?

- A annoyed
- B impressed
- C frightened
- D disgusted
- E shocked

5

'I just can't conceive how you do it at all.

I imagine you're going to a Fancy Dress Ball?' (lines 11–12)

What does this suggest about the Colonel's view of the ghost?

- A He wonders how the ghost can fly.
- B He does not believe in ghosts.
- C He does not know why the ghost bothers trying to scare people.
- D He wants to know where the ghost's cloak came from.
- E He thinks his friends have tricked him.

6

'Said the Colonel (his monocle firm in his eye)' (line 14)

What does this tell us?

- A The Colonel was not afraid.
- B The Colonel could not see the ghost very well.
- C The Colonel was wearing a fancy dress outfit.
- D The Colonel was being serious.
- E The Colonel wanted a closer look at the ghost.

7

Which adjective best describes the ghost's cloak?

- A transparent
- B translucent
- C luminous
- D black
- E silver

8

What are 'trickles of merriment'? (line 22)

- A beads of perspiration
- B drops of wine
- C laughter lines
- D tears of joy
- E tears of terror

9

Who does 'My dear fellow' refer to? (line 10)

- A the Colonel
- B a party guest
- C an animal
- D the person who sold the castle
- E the ghost

10

Why did the ghost give a 'withering cry'? (line 13)

- A The Colonel thought he was a pretend ghost.
- B The ghost was trying to scare the Colonel.
- C The Colonel offered the ghost a drink.
- D The ghost was in pain.
- E The ghost was furious.

11

How did the ghost re-enter the room?

- A He floated through the ceiling.
- B He walked through the wall.
- C He came through the chimney.
- D He walked through the window.
- E He floated through the door.

12

How do you think the Colonel felt when the ghost came back down the chimney?

- A frightened
- B anxious
- C amused
- D excited
- E irritated

13

Which of these best describes the way the ghost feels by the end of the poem?

- A exhausted
- B insulted
- C befriended
- D infuriated
- E welcomed

14

The Colonel asks the ghost to 'give us a turn!' (line 24)

Which of the following do you think the Colonel means?

- 1 scare the party guests
- 2 make the party guests turn over in their sleep
- 3 entertain the party guests
- 4 make the ghost turn around
- 5 play spinning games

- A** 1 only
- B** 4 only
- C** 5 only
- D** 1 and 2 only
- E** 1 and 3 only

15

Which of these is not something the ghost does?

- A** shiver
- B** moan
- C** cry
- D** roar
- E** walk

16

Which of these words best describes the sort of poem the author wanted to write?

- A** scary
- B** sad
- C** funny
- D** serious
- E** nonsense

Now answer the following questions about the meanings of words as they are used in the passage.

17

Which of these is the closest in meaning to 'conceive'? (line 11)

- A believe
- B decide
- C imagine
- D see
- E choose

18

What is a 'spectre'? (line 4)

- A a phantom
- B a monster
- C a visitor
- D an exciting event
- E a person who watches something

Now answer these questions about words and phrases as they are used in the passage.

19

'And floated about between ceiling and floor.' (line 18)

Which of these words is a verb?

- A and
- B floated
- C about
- D between
- E floor

20

What type of words are these?

weak/week pane/pain dear/deer

- A synonyms
- B pseudonyms
- C antonyms
- D homophones
- E homographs

In this exercise, you have to choose the **best** word, or **group of words**, to complete each numbered line so that the passage makes sense and is written in correct English. Choose the **best** answer and mark its letter on your answer sheet.

No Place to Hide

21 Put it this way.

You're

Your

Yours

You

You's

 an insect.

A

B

C

D

E

22 You're the

smaller

small

smelly

smallest

smelliest

 of the small.

A

B

C

D

E

23 You see a hungry predator

what's

that's

whiches

that

when

A

B

C

D

E

coming in your direction.

24 You hide

behind

before

beside

between

because

 a stone

A

B

C

D

E

25 or a blade of grass,

and

or

also

but

yet

 maybe in a little hole

A

B

C

D

E

26 somewhere, trying to merge

to

for

by

with

from

 your surroundings.

A

B

C

D

E

Now, just suppose there's *no* place to hide.

27 The best good well better goodly thing you can hope for is that you
A B C D E

28 look for from like as out a part of your surroundings.
A B C D E

29 If you don't, prepare to be gobbles gobbling gobble gobbled gobbly up!
A B C D E

30 If you do, nevertheless, otherwise, however, still, whereas, you have
A B C D E

31 a much improved chance to of for like by surviving. This is the way
A B C D E

32 camouflage work working worked worker works in nature.
A B C D E

This exercise contains some **spelling** mistakes. On each numbered line, there is either **one** mistake or **no** mistake. Find the group of words with the mistake in it and mark its letter on your answer sheet. **If there is no mistake, mark N.**

Spelling Exercise

33 It is said that the monarch with the shortest rain in England only ruled for two months.

A B C D

34 Yesterday, my reluctant father prepared dinner – casserole, vegetables and gravy. It was delicious.

A B C D

35 Asif was breathing heavily by the time he had pursued his sister to the summit of the hill.

A B C D

36 Your health will improve by consuming this harty breakfast, containing optimum levels of fibre.

A B C D

37 She regretfully misplaced her trainers and will now be eliminated from participating in the match.

A B C D

38 Disposing of rubbish in the ocean is harmfull to the environment and threatens aquatic habitats.

A B C D

39 Carnivorous plants flourish in habitats that are humid, near swamps and rich in nutrients.

A B C D

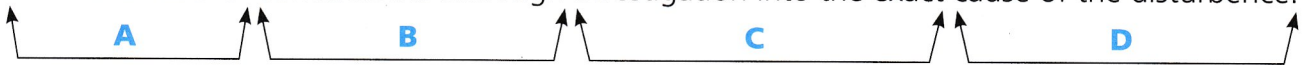
40 After school, Ismael made a pamflet about the play to distribute to everyone in the audience.

A B C D

41 The enormous inflatable slide was the most popular attraction at the amusement park:



42 The head teacher conducted a thorough investigation into the exact cause of the disturbance.



43 The atmosphere in the theatre changed dramatically when the magician disappeared.



44 The envelope contained a marvellous surprise: a trip to a popular European holiday destination.



These sentences contain some **punctuation** mistakes. On each numbered line, there is either **one** mistake or **no** mistake. Find the group of words with the mistake in it and mark its letter on your answer sheet. **If there is no mistake, mark N.**

Death by Chocolate Cake

275 g self-raising flour

$\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon baking powder

225 g caster sugar

4 tablespoons cocoa, mixed with 225 ml boiling water

1 teaspoon vanilla essence

200 g ??? *mystery ingredient*

45 We hunted around for the simplest yummiest cake to tempt all you cooks out there –
A B C D

46 and we think wev'e found it. This cake is actually made with a secret ingredient.
A B C D

47 We know it's hard to believe, but the secret is *mayonnaise* a sort of mild, creamy
A B C D

48 salad-dressing)! Give it a try and we guarantee you won't be
A B C D

49 disappointed. First, mix the cocoa with the boiling water in a large bowl then
A B C D

50 add, all the remaining ingredients and beat everything together. Pour into a lined 20 cm
A B C D

51 tin and bake on the middle shelf for about an hour at 180 degrees (Gas mark 4.)



52 Now, you didn't think we'd forgotten about the most important part, did you!



53 While the cakes baking, it's time to think about the icing.



54 We have to admit, we tend to cheat at this point the easiest



55 thing to do is buy ready-made icing from the supermarket.



56 The result will be a chocolate cake 'to die for'. Wow



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